

Flirt with Perl



Five rules you should follow.

As Damian Conway, a prominent member of the Perl community, once said, "Always code assuming that the guy who'll end up maintaining your code will be a violent psychopath who knows where you live." Writing and maintaining code can be one of the most miserable jobs if you don't follow a certain discipline in your program. At times, the way you implement a solution really matters. Most of us are just bothered about *what* to implement and are completely blind to *how*. This practice can turn a small irritant into a major headache as the volume of code grows. Here are some capsule-sized best practices to avoid such situations.

① 'Strict'ures

Assume a situation in which you are buried in a program of thousands of lines. Somewhere you have misspelled the

name of a variable, say, instead of typing `@friends_list` you punched in `@freinds_list`. You may have no idea that the code is spitting out a bad result because of this silly spelling error. It's not an easy task to figure out such bugs. Sometimes you really have to struggle for hours to check the databases, file buffers or even the whole logic to fix this naughty bug.

This situation can be easily avoided by using the pragma—*strict*. It forces the programmer to declare all variables as a



✓ No strict? You are driving your-self into an accident zone!!!

